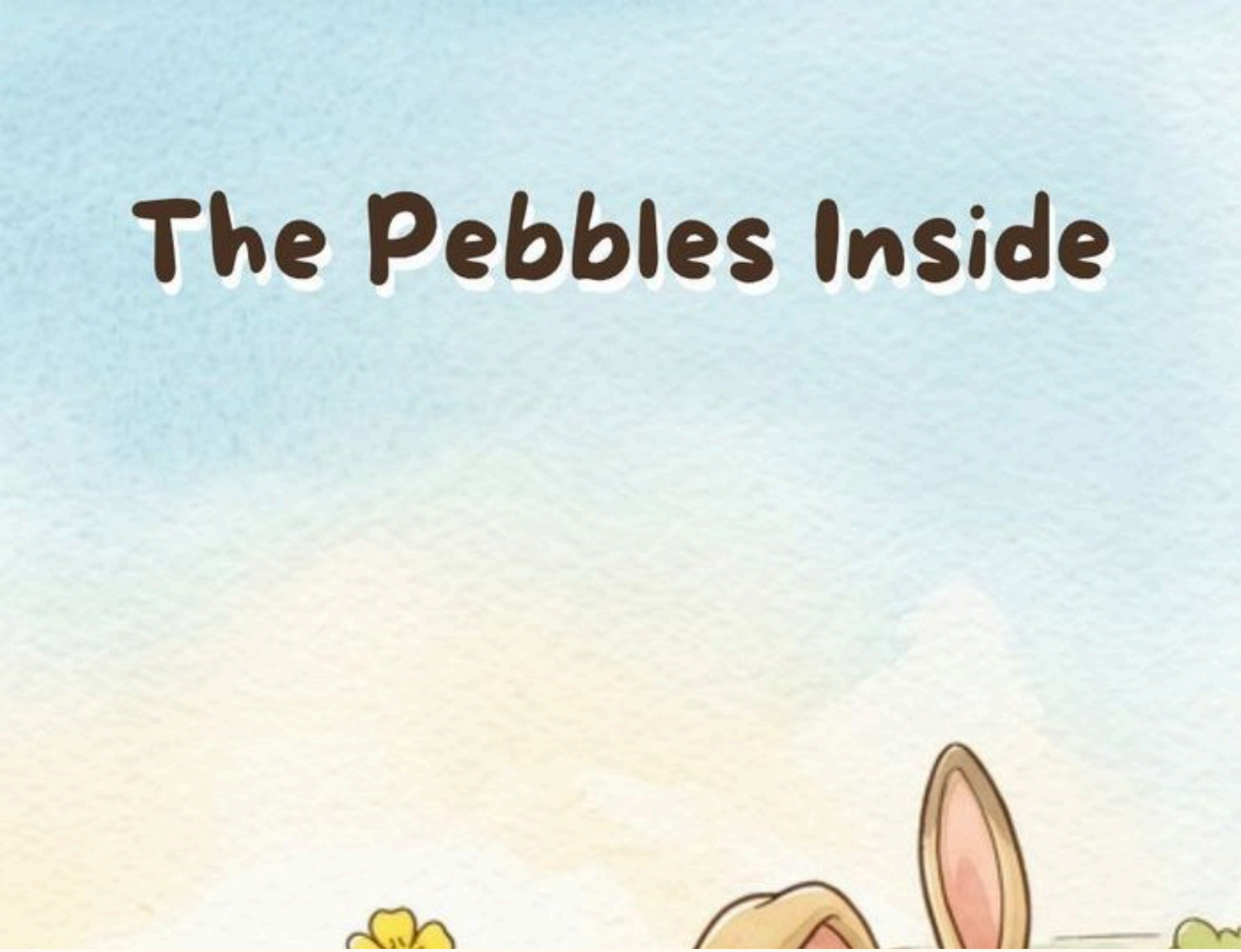


Classroom SEL pack, a week on sharing feelings, ages 3 to 7

The Pebbles Inside

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 The heavy backpack	A volunteer wears the backpack. Each time the class names a feeling someone might hide, add one soft object. Ask: Is it getting heavy? Then take them out one by one as th…	Page 8
Day 5 Pebble path	Pebble path, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Belonging and Contributing, Problem Solving and Innovating, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours

Materials

The book (or the class screen), paper pebbles in many colours (or large smooth stones for children over 3, with a grown-up), a small backpack, crayons

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English, French, Spanish, German, Italian.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: What is the turtle carrying? How do you think she feels? Ask: Have you ever said ‘I’m fine’ when you weren’t? It’s okay to say yes or just think about it. Teach the sound: every time Tavi tucks a feeling away, tap your shoulder and say ‘Click.’

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
3	The frogs laugh; Tavi says ‘I’m fine.’ Why did Tavi say ‘I’m fine’	when she wasn’t?	she didn’t want them to laugh more, she was scared, embarrassed
4	Click, click, click: a worry, a no, an idea.	Why did keeping quiet feel safe to Tavi?	no one could laugh, say no, or say she was wrong
5	Tavi’s shell grows heavy.	What happened to Tavi’s shell as she kept more feelings inside?	it got heavy, she got slow, she couldn’t climb or play
7	Fern doesn’t push; she just stays.	What did Fern do that helped Tavi feel safe?	asked softly, didn’t push, stayed, said ‘I’m here’
8	Tavi shares the first pebble.	What did Fern say when Tavi told her?	thank you for telling me, that would hurt me too
9	The biggest pebble: ‘You’re my best friend.’	Were all Tavi’s pebbles sad feelings?	no, an idea, a happy feeling, ‘you’re my best friend’
11	The frog says sorry.	Why do you think the frog laughed at Tavi?	he was scared they would laugh at him
12	The pebbles become a path.	What did the shared feelings become?	a path, stepping stones for everyone

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don’t need every stop.

Handle with care: No child should be made to share. The story shows Fern waiting kindly, and the classroom should too. More notes on the “For every child” page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

pebble

a small, smooth stone

Do it: pinch a tiny pebble between your fingers

heavy

hard to lift or carry

Do it: pretend to lift something with both arms

feeling

what happens in your heart, like happy, sad or scared

Do it: put your hand on your heart

share

to give some to someone else, or tell them

Do it: move your hands from your chest to a friend

listen

to pay attention to what someone says

Do it: cup your hand behind your ear

‘I’m fine.’ Click.

Say it together whenever it comes up in the story.

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Feelings kept inside grow heavy. Feelings we share become a path.

‘I’m fine.’ Click.

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



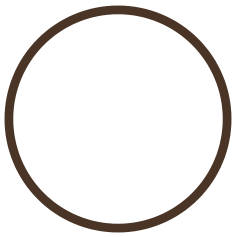
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

clip your name here

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Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

The heavy backpack

10 minutes, Whole class, Materials: A small backpack, soft objects

A volunteer wears the backpack. Each time the class names a feeling someone might hide, add one soft object. Ask: Is it getting heavy? Then take them out one by one as the class names who you could tell.

Pebble path

15 minutes, Individual, then whole class, Materials: Paper pebbles, crayons

Each child colours a paper pebble and draws or writes a feeling they would like to share (happy ones count too). Lay them together on the floor or wall as a path across a paper brook.

Listener practice

10 minutes, Pairs, Materials: None

Practise being Fern: one partner says a small feeling, the other listens, doesn't laugh, and says 'Thank you for telling me.' Swap.

Science and nature corner

Freshwater turtles live in ponds, slow streams and marshes. They bask on logs and stones and pull their head and legs into their shell to stay safe. They are slow on land but good swimmers. Hares are bigger than rabbits, with longer ears and legs, and they are very fast runners. In the story, the pebbles in Tavi's shell are make-believe: real turtles don't carry stones.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. Why did Tavi say ‘I’m fine’ when she wasn’t?

Look for: She was afraid of being laughed at, being wrong, or hearing no.

2. What happened to Tavi’s shell as she kept more feelings inside?

Look for: It got heavier and heavier until she couldn’t climb or play.

3. What did Fern do that helped Tavi feel safe to talk?

Look for: She asked gently, didn’t push, stayed, and didn’t laugh.

4. Why do you think the frog laughed at Tavi? What did he do later?

Look for: He was scared of being laughed at himself. He said sorry.

5. Who could you tell when you have a ‘pebble’ inside?

Look for: Any answer: a grown-up at home, a teacher, a friend.



Say it together

‘I’m fine.’ Click.

The big idea: Feelings we keep inside can feel heavy. Telling someone we trust makes them lighter, and good friends listen.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show sharing feelings this week. Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show sharing feelings by

Name _____



I can show sharing feelings by

Name _____



I can show sharing feelings by

Name _____



I can show sharing feelings by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Belonging and Contributing	Problem Solving and Innovating	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Notes

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Science and place corner

The willow brook has no real name, so we picked the Brenne Regional Natural Park in France. It's the best place in France to meet a European pond turtle like Tavi, along with frogs, ducks and lots of other pond life.



European pond turtle

When the weather is bad, babies can stay inside their eggs for a whole winter and hatch in spring!



European hare

In spring, hares stand up and box with their front paws. Often it's a mom telling a dad to back off!



Green water frogs

Edible frogs croak 20 to 30 times every second, in a fast rattling song.



European hedgehog

A hedgehog can lose 20–40% of its weight while it hibernates.



Mallard

The famous loud quack is mostly the mother duck calling her ducklings.

La Brenne, France

Tavi: Real pond turtles are dark brown or black with little yellow spots, not bright green like Tavi. And they don't keep pebbles on their shells! But they really do love quiet ponds and brooks.

Fern: Fern really is a hare, not a rabbit: look at those long legs and ears! Real hares mostly live alone, so a hare and a turtle best friend is story magic. The blue scarf is our artist's idea.

The frogs: Real green frogs are very noisy, so they'd be great at laughing! But a frog can't really be sorry. In the story, the little frog shows us how.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-pebbles-inside

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Use feeling cards with faces (happy, sad, scared, excited) so children can point instead of talk. ‘Click’ is easy for everyone to join.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 3, 7 and 12). Hold a real (large) stone or a paper pebble while reading so the idea is easy to see.

Quiet children

Never force anyone to share. Let children draw their pebble, whisper it to you, or keep it in their pocket. Being a quiet listener is a gift too.

Handle with care

No child should be made to share. The story shows Fern waiting kindly, and the classroom should too.

This guide is not therapy. If a child seems withdrawn or worried for a long time, talk with their family and your school team.

Real stones can be a choking hazard for under-3s. Use paper pebbles or very large stones with a grown-up close by.

Where this value comes from

This story doesn’t come from one culture. An old Norse poem says that worry eats the heart if you can’t tell a friend all your thoughts, and an ancient Egyptian tale says how happy is the one who can tell what they went through, once the bad time has passed.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read The Pebbles Inside, a story about sharing our feelings. Tavi the turtle keeps every feeling inside until her shell is too heavy to carry, and her friend Fern helps by simply listening. At home, ask your child, 'Is there a pebble you'd like to share today?' Happy pebbles count too. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu Les cailloux de Tavi, une histoire sur le partage des émotions. Tavi la tortue garde tout à l'intérieur jusqu'à ce que sa carapace soit trop lourde, et son amie Fern l'aide simplement en l'écoutant. À la maison, demandez à votre enfant : « As-tu un caillou à partager aujourd'hui ? » Les cailloux joyeux comptent aussi. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre compartir lo que sentimos. Tavi, la tortuga, guarda cada sentimiento hasta que su caparazón pesa demasiado, y su amiga Fern la ayuda simplemente escuchándola. En casa, pregunte a su hijo o hija: «¿Hay alguna piedrita que quieras compartir hoy?» Las piedritas felices también cuentan. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte darüber gelesen, Gefühle zu teilen. Die Schildkröte Tavi behält jedes Gefühl für sich, bis ihr Panzer zu schwer wird, und ihre Freundin Fern hilft, indem sie einfach zuhört. Fragen Sie Ihr Kind zu Hause: ‚Gibt es heute einen Kieselstein, den du teilen möchtest?' Fröhliche Kiesel zählen auch. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sul condividere le emozioni. Tavi, la tartaruga, tiene ogni emozione dentro di sé finché il guscio diventa troppo pesante, e la sua amica Fern la aiuta semplicemente ascoltandola. A casa, chiedete a vostro figlio o vostra figlia: «C'è un sassolino che vuoi condividere oggi?» Anche i sassolini felici contano. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Sharing feelings: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Sharing feelings: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Sharing feelings: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

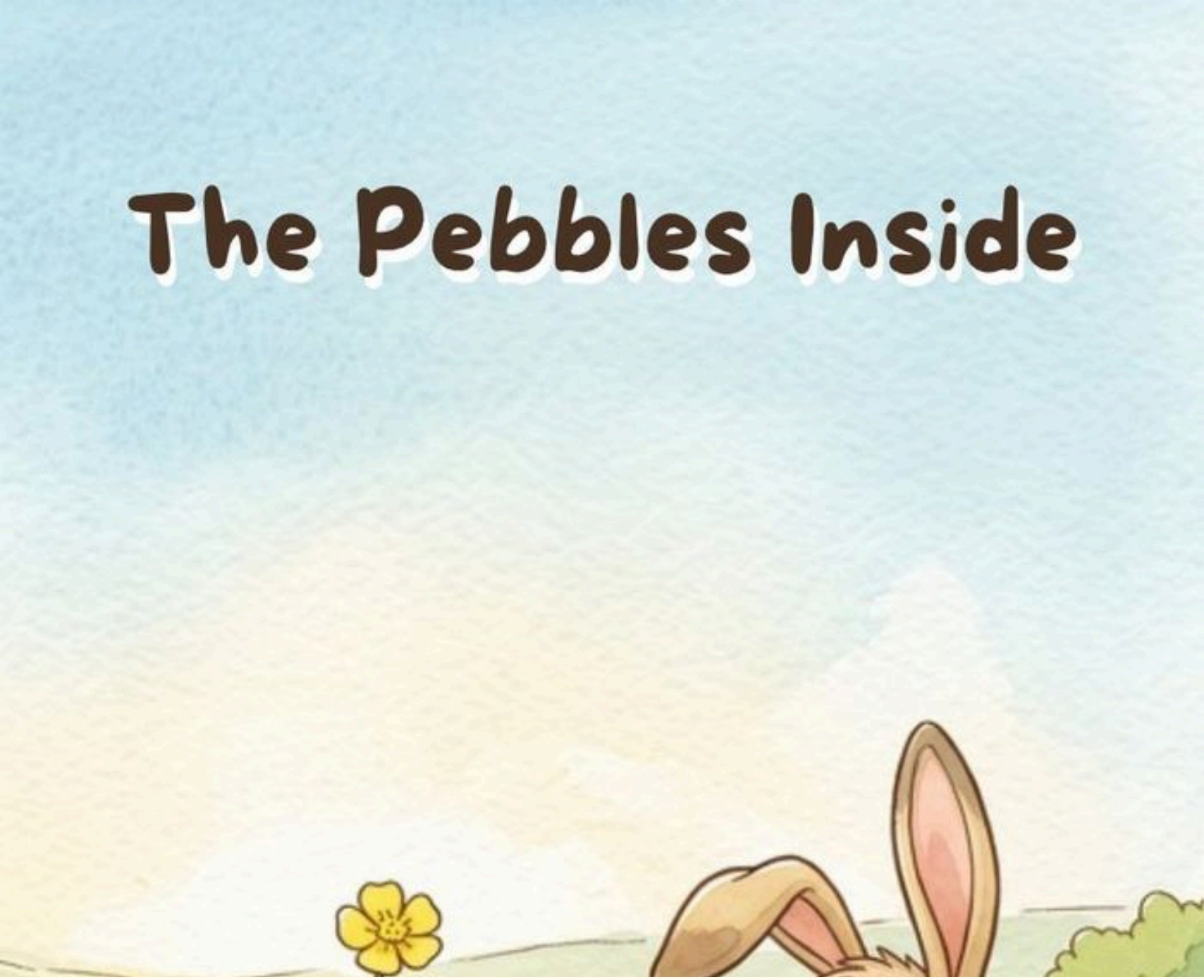
Sharing feelings: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Pebbles Inside

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: sharing feelings.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Feelings we keep inside can feel heavy. Telling someone we trust makes them lighter, and good friends listen.

Say it together

‘I’m fine.’ Click.

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
pebble	a small, smooth stone	pinch a tiny pebble between your fingers
heavy	hard to lift or carry	pretend to lift something with both arms
feeling	what happens in your heart, like happy, sad or scared	put your hand on your heart
share	to give some to someone else, or tell them	move your hands from your chest to a friend
listen	to pay attention to what someone says	cup your hand behind your ear

A gentle note

This guide is not therapy. If a child seems withdrawn or worried for a long time, talk with their family and your school team.

Real stones can be a choking hazard for under-3s. Use paper pebbles or very large stones with a grown-up close by.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

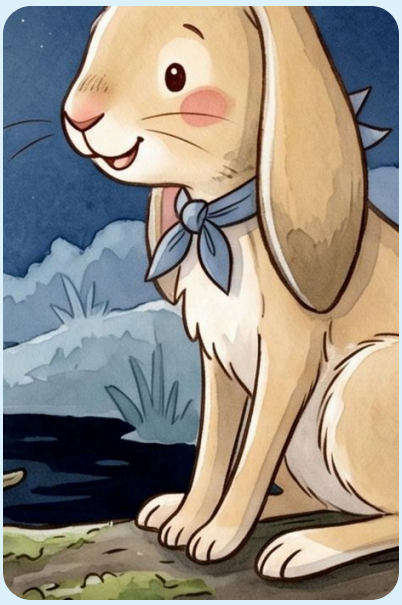
Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Tavi

European pond turtle

The quiet turtle who learns to share what she carries



Fern

European hare

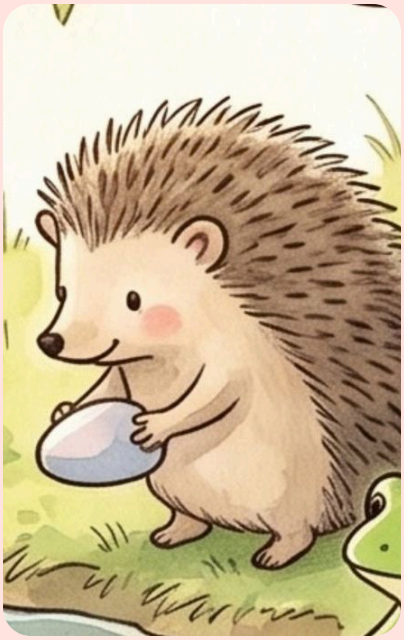
The best friend who sits down and stays



The frogs

Green water frogs

They laughed, then one came to say sorry



The hedgehog

European hedgehog

Brings a pebble for the path



The duck

Mallard

Sets down a pebble she had kept inside

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How did they feel?

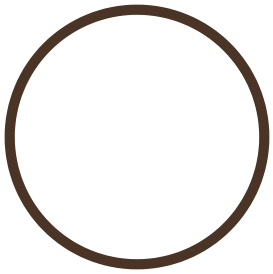
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

The frogs laugh; Tavi says ‘I’m fine.’ Why did Tavi say ‘I’m fine’

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

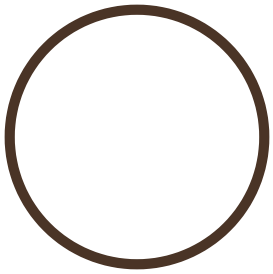


Moment 2

Tavi shares the first pebble.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

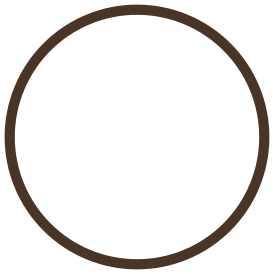


Moment 3

The pebbles become a path.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

pebble a small, smooth stone

pebble pebble

heavy hard to lift or carry

heavy heavy

feeling what happens in your heart, like happy, sad or scared

feeling feeling

Tavi the hero of the story

Tavi Tavi

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Tavi showed sharing feelings. Draw a time when you showed sharing feelings too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

The heavy backpack

You need: A small backpack, soft objects

A volunteer wears the backpack. Each time the class names a feeling someone might hide, add one soft object. Ask: Is it getting heavy? Then take them out one by one as the class names who you could tell.

Pebble feelings

Find a few smooth pebbles. Hold one and say one feeling out loud. Put it down. Feel lighter?

Stepping stones

Make a path with cushions or paper 'stones'. Say one thing you feel on each step.

Hare hop

How far can you jump? A hare can leap about 3 metres!

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Pebbles Inside are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Tavi

European pond turtle

When the weather is bad, babies can stay inside their eggs for a whole winter and hatch in spring!



Fern

European hare

In spring, hares stand up and box with their front paws. Often it's a mom telling a dad to back off!



The frogs

Green water frogs

Edible frogs croak 20 to 30 times every second, in a fast rattling song.



The hedgehog

European hedgehog

A hedgehog can lose 20–40% of its weight while it hibernates.

Story or real?

Real pond turtles are dark brown or black with little yellow spots, not bright green like Tavi. And they don't keep pebbles on their shells! But they really do love quiet ponds and brooks.

Where they really live

The willow brook has no real name, so we picked the Brenne Regional Natural Park in France. It's the best place in France to meet a European pond turtle like Tavi, along with frogs, ducks and lots of other pond life.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-pebbles-inside

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What is the turtle carrying? How do you think she feels?

The Pebbles Inside, talk card 1

Why did Tavi say ‘I’m fine’ when she wasn’t?

The Pebbles Inside, talk card 2

What happened to Tavi’s shell as she kept more feelings inside?

The Pebbles Inside, talk card 3

What did Fern do that helped Tavi feel safe to talk?

The Pebbles Inside, talk card 4

Why do you think the frog laughed at Tavi? What did he do later?

The Pebbles Inside, talk card 5

Who could you tell when you have a ‘pebble’ inside?

The Pebbles Inside, talk card 6

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Sharing feelings hero

This is to say that

_____

showed sharing feelings, just like Tavi.

‘I’m fine.’ Click.

Signed _____ Date _____

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